SleepWell: A Survey Study of Sleep Habits and Academic Performance Among University Students

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Abstract

We surveyed 1,250 university students about their sleep habits and academic performance. Students who slept at least 7 hours per night had an average grade point average 0.35 points higher than students who slept less than 6 hours.

1 Introduction

Sleep is important for memory, attention and mood. University students often sleep less than recommended because of study, work and screen use.

Earlier studies used small samples from a single campus. This study uses a larger sample from several universities.

2 Method

Data was collected through an online questionnaire sent to students of six universities during the spring semester of 2024.

Participants reported their bedtime, wake-up time and screen use before sleep. Sleep duration was calculated from these answers and compared with the grade point average reported by each student.

3 Results

The average sleep duration was 6.4 hours. 58 percent of students reported using a phone in bed.

Students who stopped using screens 30 minutes before bed fell asleep 18 minutes earlier on average than the other students.

4 Conclusion

Sleep duration is linked to academic performance in our sample. We recommend that universities avoid scheduling classes before 9 AM.

Because the data is self-reported, the results show an association and not a cause.

References

[1] M. Walker. Why We Sleep. 2017.

[2] A. Lee et al. Sleep and grades in college students. 2019.